

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

(This is a two-page report. Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.)

2000-45
[A]

Each table cell will automatically enlarge as you type!

CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name): Pomarine Jaeger		(Scientific Name) Stercorarius pomarinus
Date(s) of occurrence: October 12-13, 2000		
Number of birds seen: One	Sex: Unknown	Plumage: Adult light morph
Exact Location: Chatfield Reservoir		
County: Jefferson	Nearest town: Littleton	Elevation: 5432 msl
Length of observation: Approximately 25 minutes		Time(s) of observation: Late afternoon on the 12th and morning of the 13th.
Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: None		
Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s): I believe others saw this bird but I cannot remember whom.		
Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position: Good overall. Conditions on the 12th were not as good since the sun was setting and the bird was mainly to the west of me. However, on the morning of the 13th, the bird was mainly to the west and the sun was to the east of me.		
Optical equipment used: 8x40 Swift Bins, 32x Spotting Scope		
Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): Varied. Closest distance was perhaps 70 yards.		
Was bird(s) photographed? Yes (video)		If so, have you submitted photos? Yes (video and stills)
Who took the photographs? Myself		
Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: Open water lake		

Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the Species or in supporting the identification): **Bird chased gulls often in flight. The jaeger was also observed loafing on the water.**

Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes):

Having heard of a Pomarine Jaeger and Parasitic Jaegers being reported from Chatfield Reservoir the previous day, I arrived at the marina the following morning and began scoping the water. Almost immediately I observed an adult Pomarine Jaeger flying low and direct over the water at a considerable view (roughly a quarter mile). Over the course of the next 20 minutes, I observed the bird from various distances, some as close as perhaps 60 yards. I was able to video the Pomarine and have enclosed some poor quality digital stills from that video.

The bird was large, being roughly equivalent to that of a California Gull in size. It was obviously a jaeger with dark brown wings, a dark helmet over the head, whitish-yellow neck, white belly, and brown vent, rump, and tail. Noticeable was two elongated central rectrices as well. In flight, it seemed powerful, deliberate, and steady and not as quick or falcon-like as Parasitic, nor as buoyant or floppy as that of a Long-tailed. The head was large and rounded, not flat-crowned as with Parasitic. The wings were quite wide-based and when in flight, swept back and overhead when in pursuit of nearby gulls. With a wing shape that was somewhat bat-like. When in a soar over the water, the bird would hold its' wings stiff and pointed downward, almost reminiscent of that of a shearwater. The belly was deep, which formed an "S" shape to the bird's profile when in flight. The tail was long because of two elongated central rectrices that were quite broad and rounded. Upon closer examination, the following traits were observed:

Head and Bill – The bill was two-toned but since the bird was in flight, I could not discern any relationship extents between the



two tones or the bill size. There was a dark brown, helmet-shaped cap on the head of the bird that extended from the rear-crown ventro-anteriorly to behind the eye and to the malar and then to just below the bill (seemingly more extensive than the dark cap of a Parasitic). The eyes appeared dark. The rear of the head and the neck was a whitish-yellow.

Upperparts – When swimming, all the upperparts appeared dark brown. When in flight, the broad-based wings contained extensive white shafts to the upper primaries, certainly more extensive than that of a Long-tailed Jaeger. From beneath, there was a wide, white arc at the base of the outer primaries. The rump appeared dark brown as well.

Underparts – The throat and belly were whitish and were partially separated by a hint of a breast band that may not have even joined to form a band across the breast, with most of the breast being whitish-crème colored (suggestive of a male?). This broken dark band emanated from the dark axillaries and dorsal edge of the belly and breast. The vent was dark brown as well and extended anteriorly into the lower belly.

Tail – When in flight, the dark tail appeared long and tapered. When the bird banked, however, it was noticed that the tail was somewhat rounded except for the two elongated central rectrices. These central feathers were wide and blob-tipped and extended past the rest of the rectrices by about 8 inches or so. They were not as long or spoon-shaped as on other adult Pomarine Jaegers I have seen.



Describe bird's call or song: **None heard**

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them: **See above**

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? **At the time of observation, I had observed other at least three other Pom's in Colorado and had observed the species numerous times before in Texas, Louisiana, California, the East Coast, and Scotland.**

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): **None**

This report is from notes made during or after **XX** observation or later from memory

Date of written report: **11/01/01**

Reporting observer: **Larry Semo**

Signature:

A handwritten signature in cursive script that reads "Larry Semo".

Reporting Observer's Address: **9054 Dover Street**

City: **Westminster**

State: **Colorado**

Zip: **80021**

Send report to:
Colorado Birds Record Committee
c/o Tony Leukering